

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 44

The Asma' ul Mawsulah

1. The definition of the Ism ul Mawsul

The word *Mawsul* comes from the Arabic root **وصل**, whose meaning is **to join**.

Definition: In grammatical terms an *Ism ul Mawsul* is a word that does the work of **joining two sentences together**. It performs two offices at once: that of joining, and that of a pronoun.

A comparison with English

In English the words "who", "which" and "that" serve this purpose.

Two separate sentences	Joined into one
this is a boy · he met me yesterday	this is the boy who met me yesterday
this is a boy · I met him yesterday	this is the boy whom I met yesterday

The Arabic words standing in the place of these are called the *Asma' ul Mawsulah*.

The basic characteristic: An *Ism ul Mawsul* is a noun whose full meaning is **not understood until a clause is joined to it**.

2. The Ma'rifah Asma' ul Mawsulah

Since Arabic is a most wide and eloquent language, it has separate masculine and feminine *Asma' ul Mawsulah* for the singular, the dual and the plural. In respect of *wus'at* these are *Ma'rifah*.

Gender	Wahid	Tathniyah — raf'	Tathniyah — nasb & jarr	Jam'
masculine	الَّذِي	الَّذَانِ	الَّذَيْنِ	الَّذِينَ
feminine	الَّتِي	الَّتَانِ	الَّتَيْنِ	الَّتِي / اللَّائِي

Three important rules

- The **أل** at their beginning is a necessary part of them. When a word comes before it, the *Hamzat ul Wasl* of the **al-** is written only, and is not shown in reading.
- The singular and plural *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are *Mabni*, while the dual ones are *Mu'rab*.
- In the dual, the sound **تَانِ** comes for the state of *raf'* and the sound **تَيْنِ** for the states of *nasb* and *jarr*.

Their use in the Qur'an

Ism ul Mawsul	Kind	In the Qur'an
الَّذِي	singular masculine	very frequently
الَّذِينَ	plural masculine	very frequently
الَّتِي	singular feminine	about 67 times
الَّتِي	plural feminine	10 times
اللَّائِي	plural feminine	4 times
the dual forms	dual	very seldom; some only once, and some not at all

So it is mostly the *Mabni Asma' ul Mawsulah* that are used in the Qur'an.

Examples from the Qur'an

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فِرَاشًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً

(Surah al-Baqarah: 22)

Translation: He who made the earth a bed for you and the sky a canopy.

الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ وَيُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 3)

Translation: Those who believe in the unseen, establish the prayer, and spend out of what We have provided them.

Two rare examples of the dual

وَالَّذَانِ يَأْتِيَنِهَا مِنْكُمْ فَأَذُوهُمَا

(Surah an-Nisa: 16)

Translation: And the two among you who commit it — punish them both.

This is an example of **الَّذَانِ** — the dual masculine in the state of *raf'*.

وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا رَبَّنَا أَرِنَا الَّذِينَ أَضَلَّانَا مِنَ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسِ

(Surah Fussilat: 29)

Translation: And those who disbelieved will say: our Lord, show us the two who misled us among the jinn and mankind.

This is an example of **الَّذَيْنِ** — the dual masculine in the state of *nasb*.

3. The Silat ul Mawsul

Definition: The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are *mubham* — vague — that is, their meaning is not plain. So a clause is brought after them for the sense to become clear. That clause is called the *Silat ul Mawsul*.

In about 99.99 percent of places the *Silat ul Mawsul* is a *Jumla Fi'liyyah*, but in the remaining places it may also come as a *Jumla Ismiyyah* or a *Shibh Jumlah*.

The three kinds of Silah

Kind	Definition	Example
Jumla Fi'liyyah	a clause with a verb comes after the Ism ul Mawsul — this is the commonest case by far	الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ
Jumla Ismiyyah	a complete nominal sentence, a Muftada with its Khabar, comes after it	الَّذِي هُوَ أَذْنَى
Shibh Jumlah	a jarr with its majroor, or an Ism uz Zarf with a Murakkab Idafi	الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ

Why Shibh Jumlah?: The name means that there is a *shubhah*, a semblance, of its being a sentence; but in truth it is not a sentence — for a sentence requires a *Muftada* with a *Khabar*, or a verb with its doer.

A reminder about the Ism uz Zarf

A *zarf* is a noun conveying the sense of time or place, and in a sentence it generally comes as the *Mudaf*.

- *Zarf ul Makan*: فَوْقَ ، تَحْتَ ، أَمَامَ
- *Zarf uz Zaman*: قَبْلَ ، بَعْدَ ، أَبَدًا

4. A Jumla Ismiyyah as the Silah

An important principle: When a complete *Jumla Ismiyyah* comes after the *Ism ul Mawsul*, that whole clause is called its *Silah*. And then the *Ism ul Mawsul* joins with its *Silah* to become the *Mubtada*, and the word after it is the *Khabar*.

In all four forms

The sentence	Translation
الَّذِي هُوَ جَالِسٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ مُعَلِّمٌ	he who is seated in the mosque is a teacher
الَّذِينَ هُمْ جَالِسُونَ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ مُعَلِّمُونَ	those who are seated in the mosque are teachers
الَّتِي هِيَ جَالِسَةٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ مُعَلِّمَةٌ	she who is seated in the mosque is a teacher
الَّتِي هُنَّ جَالِسَاتٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ مُعَلِّمَاتٌ	those women who are seated in the mosque are teachers

An analysis of the first example:

Element	Details
الَّذِي	the <i>Ism ul Mawsul</i>
هُوَ جَالِسٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ	a <i>Jumla Ismiyyah</i> , which is the <i>Silat ul Mawsul</i>
مُعَلِّمٌ	the <i>Khabar</i>

That is, the *Ism ul Mawsul* joined with its *Silah* to become the *Mubtada*, and the *Mubtada* with its *Khabar* completed the whole *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

Examples from the Qur'an

تَبَارَكَ الَّذِي بِيَدِهِ الْمُلْكُ

(Surah al-Mulk: 1)

Translation: Blessed is He in whose hand is the dominion.

Element	Details
الَّذِي	the <i>Ism ul Mawsul</i>
بِيَدِهِ الْمُلْكُ	a <i>Jumla Ismiyyah</i> as the <i>Silah</i> , in which <i>بِيَدِهِ</i> , a jarr with its majroor, is the <i>Khabar Muqaddam</i> and <i>الْمُلْكُ</i> the <i>Mubtada Mu'akhkhar</i>

A point of rhetoric: The original order was **أَلْمَلِكُ بِيَدِهِ**, but here the bringing forward and setting back was done to produce **Hasr and exclusiveness** — that is, that dominion belongs to Allah alone.

أَتَسْتَبْدِلُونَ الَّذِي هُوَ أَدْنَىٰ بِالَّذِي هُوَ خَيْرٌ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 61)

Translation: Would you exchange that which is inferior for that which is better?

In this verse the *Ism ul Mawsul* comes twice with its *Silah*. The *Silah* of the first **الَّذِي** is **هُوَ أَدْنَىٰ**, and of the second **هُوَ خَيْرٌ** — both being a *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 24)

Translation: Then fear the Fire whose fuel is people and stones.

Here **الَّتِي** is the *Ism ul Mawsul* and **وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ** the *Jumla Ismiyyah* as its *Silah*, in which **وَقُودُهَا** is the *Mubtada* and **النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ** the *Khabar*.

5. A Shibh Jumlah as the Silah

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اعْبُدُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 21)

Translation: O people, worship your Lord who created you and those before you, so that you may become mindful of Him.

In this single verse there are two *Asma' ul Mawsulah*, and the *Silah* of each is of a different kind.

Ism ul Mawsul	Its Silah	Kind of Silah
الَّذِي	خَلَقَكُمْ	Jumla Fi'liyyah
الَّذِينَ	مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ	Shibh Jumlah — a Murakkab Jarri

Further examples of a Murakkab Jarri as the Silah

The sentence	Translation
الَّذِي فِي الْبَيْتِ صَالِحٌ	he who is in the house is righteous
الَّتِي فِي الْبَيْتِ صَالِحَةٌ	she who is in the house is righteous
الَّذِي لَهُ مُلْكُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ	He to whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth

In the last example **الَّذِي** is the *Ism ul Mawsul* and **لَهُ مُلْكُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ** the *jarr* with its *majroor* standing as its *Silah*.

A Jumla Fi'liyyah as the Silah

الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 3)

Translation: Those who believe in the unseen.

After the *Ism ul Mawsul* **الَّذِينَ** comes **يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ**, which is a *Jumla Fi'liyyah* as its *Silah*. This is the commonest case.

6. The Nakirah Asma' ul Mawsulah

Definition: In Arabic there are certain *Asma' ul Mawsulah* that are used **alike, in one and the same form**, for masculine and feminine, singular, dual and plural, and that remain **Mabni** in all three states of *I'raab*.

Ism ul Mawsul	Meaning	Use
مَنْ	who	generally for the 'aqil — for singular, dual and plural, masculine and feminine alike
مَا	whatever	for the ghayr 'aqil. This مَا is called the Ma Mawsulah
إِذَا	when	for time
حَيْثُ	where	for place
أَيُّ	whichever, who	for Dhawi al-'Uqool — أَيُّ, أَيَّا, أَيِّ in the three states

Of these the two most important are مَنْ and مَا.

The basic difference between Ma and Man

The general rule: مَا is used for the **ghayr 'aqil** — inanimate things, plants and animals — while مَنْ is reserved for **rational creatures**: human beings, jinn and angels.

But some latitude: This is a general rule. In some places in the Qur'an the reverse use is also found, under the requirements of rhetoric and wisdom.

Examples of Ma

مَا عَلَى الْمَكْتَبِ لِرَیْدٍ

(whatever is on the desk belongs to Zayd)

Here مَا is the *Ism ul Mawsul* and عَلَى الْمَكْتَبِ, a *jarr* with its *majroor*, is its *Silah*.

لِلَّهِ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 284)

Translation: To Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth.

Here مَا has come for all **ghayr 'aqil** things.

A point of rhetoric: The original grammatical order of this verse was مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ لِلَّهِ, that is, the *Mubtada* first and the *Khabar* after. By bringing the *Khabar* لِلَّهِ forward and setting the *Mubtada* back, the sense of **Hasr and exclusiveness** has arisen in the sentence.

And the *Ism ul Mawsul* مَا with its *Silabs* together becomes the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*.

An example of Man

أَلَا إِنَّ لِلَّهِ مَنْ فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ

(Surah Yunus: 66)

Translation: Unquestionably, to Allah belongs whoever is in the heavens and whoever is on the earth.

Here لِلَّهِ is the *Khabar Muqaddam* and مَنْ with its *Silabs* the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*. And here مَنْ has been used for rational creatures — human beings, angels and jinn.

7. Both Man and Ma in one verse

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ اِنِّىْ جَاعِلٌ فِى الْاَرْضِ خَلِيْفَةًۭ ۖ قَالُوْۤا اَتَجْعَلُ فِیْهَا مَنْ یُّفْسِدُ فِیْهَا وَیَسْفِكُ الدِّمَآءَ وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَۙ قَالَ اِنِّىْۤ اَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُوْنَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 30)

Translation: And when your Lord said to the angels: I am going to place a successor on the earth. They said: will You place upon it one who will spread corruption therein and shed blood, while we declare Your praise and sanctify You? He said: I know what you do not know.

In this one verse both *Asma' ul Mawsulah* have come together, and the use of each is perfectly fitting in its place.

Ism ul Mawsul	Its Silah	Explanation
مَنْ	يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا وَيَسْفِكُ الدِّمَاءَ	in the speech of the angels it has come for the 'aqil, that is, for human beings
مَا	لَا تَعْلَمُونَ	in the answer of Allah it has come for the ghayr 'aqil, that is, for matters and wisdoms

An analysis of the Silah of Man: Its *Silah* there is a *Murakkab 'Atfi*. In that construction *يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا* is the *ma'toof 'alayh*, the waw is the *Harf ul 'Atf*, and *يَسْفِكُ الدِّمَاءَ* is the *ma'toof*. These two together form the *Murakkab 'Atfi* that has become the *Silah* of the *Ism ul Mawsul*.

8. Three practical points

- After the *Asma' ul Mawsulah* you will most often find a *Jumla Fi'liyyah*.
- The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* can become the *Mubtada*.
- In a *Jumla Ismiyyah* the *Ism ul Mawsul* joins with its *Silah* to form a single unit, and the *Khabar* comes after it.

Practical examples

The sentence	Translation
الَّذِي هُوَ قَائِمٌ صَالِحٌ	he who is standing is righteous
الَّتِي هِيَ قَائِمَةٌ صَالِحَةٌ	she who is standing is righteous
الَّذِي هُوَ اَدْنٰى بِالَّذِي هُوَ خَيْرٌ	that which is inferior for that which is better
الَّذِينَ هُمْ فِي صَلَاتِهِمْ خٰشِعُونَ	those who are humbly submissive in their prayer
الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ	those who are heedless of their prayer

In the first example **الَّذِي هُوَ قَائِمٌ** as a whole became the *Mubtada*, and **صَالِحٌ** the *Khabar*.

Consider the last two: These are verses of Surah al-Mu'minun and Surah al-Ma'un. The words are nearly the same — **عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ** and **فِي صَلَاتِهِمْ** — yet from the difference of a single *Harf ul Jarr* the sense turns entirely about: the one are humble within their prayer, the other heedless of it altogether.

Summary

1. The word Mawsul comes from the Arabic root wasl, whose meaning is to join.
2. An Ism ul Mawsul is a word that joins two sentences together, performing at once the office of joining and that of a pronoun.
3. In English the words "who", "which" and "that" serve this purpose.
4. The full meaning of an Ism ul Mawsul is not understood until a clause is joined to it.
5. The Ma'rifah Asma' ul Mawsulah have separate masculine and feminine forms for the singular, dual and plural.
6. The al- at their beginning is a necessary part of them, and its Hamzat ul Wasl is written only, not read.
7. The singular and plural Asma' ul Mawsulah are Mabni, while the dual ones are Mu'rab.
8. In the dual, the sound آلِ comes for raf' and آَيْنِ for nasb and jarr.
9. In the Qur'an الَّذِي and الَّذِينَ occur most often, آَلَيْ about 67 times, and the feminine plural 14 times in all.
10. The dual Asma' ul Mawsulah occur very seldom in the Qur'an; some only once, and some not at all.
11. The Asma' ul Mawsulah are vague, so the clause brought after them is called the Silat ul Mawsul.
12. In about 99.99 percent of places the Silah is a Jumla Fi'liyyah.
13. The Silah is of three kinds: a Jumla Fi'liyyah, a Jumla Ismiyyah, and a Shibh Jumlah.
14. A Shibh Jumlah means a jarr with its majroor, or an Ism uz Zarf with a Murakkab Idafi; it is so called because there is a semblance of its being a sentence, though it is not.
15. When the Silah is a Jumla Ismiyyah, the Ism ul Mawsul joins with it to become the Muftada, and the word after is the Khabar.
16. In آَلَمُلْكُ بِيَدِهِ تَبَرَّكَ الَّذِي بِيَدِهِ الْمُلْكُ the original order was آَلَمُلْكُ بِيَدِهِ, but it was inverted to produce Hasr.
17. In verse 21 of Surah al-Baqarah there are two Asma' ul Mawsulah: the Silah of one a Jumla Fi'liyyah and of the other a Shibh Jumlah.
18. Some Asma' ul Mawsulah are Nakirah and stay the same for masculine, feminine, singular, dual and plural alike.
19. These are five: أَيُّ, مَنْ, مَا, إِذْ, حَيْثُ.
20. مَا comes for the ghayr 'aqil and مَنْ for rational creatures, though under rhetoric the Qur'an also has the reverse.
21. In آَللهِ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ the Khabar was brought forward to produce Hasr and exclusiveness.
22. In verse 30 of Surah al-Baqarah both مَنْ and مَا come together — the first for man and the second for the wisdoms of Allah.
23. The Silah of مَنْ there is a Murakkab 'Atfi: يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا the ma'toof 'alayh, the waw the Harf ul 'Atf, and يَسْفِكُ الدَّمَاءَ the ma'toof.
24. The Asma' ul Mawsulah can become the Muftada, and they join with their Silah to form a single unit.

Exercise

1. Define the Ism ul Mawsul and state which two offices it performs.
2. Explain the joining of two sentences with two examples.
3. Set out the complete table of the Ma'rifah Asma' ul Mawsulah.
4. What is the ruling on the al- at their beginning?
5. Which Asma' ul Mawsulah are Mabni and which Mu'rab?
6. State how frequently each Ism ul Mawsul is used in the Qur'an.
7. Write both Qur'anic examples of the dual and state the I'raab of each.
8. Define the Silat ul Mawsul and state why it is needed.
9. Write all three kinds of Silah with definitions and examples.
10. What is a Shibh Jumlah, and why was it given that name?
11. Form examples of a Jumla Ismiyyah as the Silah in all four forms.
12. Give a full analysis of تَبْرَكَ الَّذِي يَدِيَهِ الْمُلْكُ and state the reason for the inversion.
13. Separate the Muftada and Khabar of the Silah in فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ.
14. State both Asma' ul Mawsulah and their Silahs in verse 21 of Surah al-Baqarah.
15. Which are the Nakirah Asma' ul Mawsulah? Set them out in a table.
16. What is the basic difference in the use of مَنْ and مَا?
17. What was the original grammatical order of يَلِيهِ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ, and what sense did the change produce?
18. Take out both Asma' ul Mawsulah and their Silahs from verse 30 of Surah al-Baqarah.
19. What is meant by a Murakkab 'Atfi? Give the example from that same verse.
20. Explain the difference between الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ and الَّذِينَ هُمْ فِي صَلَاتِهِمْ خَاشِعُونَ.

The completion of the course

This is the final lesson of Lisan ul Quran. Across forty-four lessons the journey has run from the letters of the alphabet to the Asma' ul Mawsulah. Along the way have come the four aspects of the noun, the six kinds of Murakkab Naqis, the whole structure of the Jumla Ismiyyah, the Huroof ul Jarrah, the Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l, negation, emphasis, calling and questioning — all of it studied from the examples of the Qur'an itself.

All of it was for this: that the Book of Allah might be understood directly. The real work begins now — opening the Qur'an each day and recognising these very rules within it.

رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّا إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ

Our Lord, accept this from us. Indeed You are the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.